Jarrod Tran

Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy
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SUMMARY

I turn ambiguous mandates into operating systems that move. Strategist and operator: set what, where, and when; scale and launch; hand off to a sustaining team. At Tesla Energy Manufacturing I own AI enablement for 10,000 employees and lead an FDE team for custom buildouts, with factory strategy and cost/regulatory mitigation beside that work. Prior Waymo Strategy & Ops, Apple iPhone India launch, Tesla 4680 special projects, Amazon fulfillment ops.

SELECTED RESULTS

- Tesla: $260M annualized cost-down; $156M incremental annual profit from a $23M / 50+ initiative portfolio
- Tesla: $550M projected tariff exposure mitigated; Megapack production scale 3.2x
- Tesla: 10k+ Energy Manufacturing employees on AI enablement; FDE custom buildouts (20+ tools, 1,000+ users, ~$1.6M productivity)
- Apple: India revenue $2B->$10B; units 4.3M->16.9M; exports 6 to 40+ countries

EXPERIENCE

Tesla - Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy | Aug 2023 - Present
- Sequence a $23M / 50+ initiative portfolio: $260M annualized cost-down, $156M incremental annual profit; Megapack scale 3.2x - then hand the playbooks to sustaining owners.
- Mitigate $550M in projected tariff exposure by redesigning build plans and standing up FTZ, bonded-warehouse, and changeover infrastructure.
- Lead AI enablement across Tesla Energy Manufacturing (10,000 employees): as-is to to-be to ship to hand-off to a sustaining team.
- Stand up an FDE team for custom AI buildouts (20+ tools, 1,000+ active users, ~$1.6M productivity).
- Own strategy on what we build, where we build it, and when we launch, plus regulatory and cost mitigation.

Waymo - Strategy & Operations Manager | Oct 2022 - May 2023
- Replaced ad-hoc Engineering Operations reporting with one decision system across hardware, software, fleet, product, and legal: annual planning, OKRs, resource plans, business reviews, and decision milestones.

Apple - Strategic Operations Program Manager | Jun 2021 - Jun 2022
- Built the zero-to-one operating system for iPhone manufacturing in India under exacting quality, regulatory, and timing requirements.
- Shipped the ramp: revenue $2B->$10B, units 4.3M->16.9M, exports expanded from 6 to 40+ countries - then handed the running operation to plant and supplier teams.

Tesla - Program Manager, Special Projects | Jun 2018 - Jun 2021
- Took Project Roadrunner (4680) from early battery-cell pilot to a production-ready platform, then handed stage gates and launch ownership to engineering, production, and supply chain.
- Sustained Model 3 / Model Y rates through demand surges and supply disruptions.
- Designed and launched a $3.5M/month Warehouse on Wheels logistics platform protecting battery and drivetrain flow.

Amazon - Operations Area Manager | Mar 2017 - Apr 2018
- Led a team of 100+ associates in a high-volume fulfillment center.

SKILLS

AI enablement and adoption | Factory and operating strategy | Special projects / launch readiness | Capacity and cost economics | Decision systems and executive cadence | Zero-to-one manufacturing launches

EDUCATION

University at Buffalo - B.S. Business Administration, Finance (Cum Laude)